

to be encoded. Different encoding schemes exist, like yEnc, MIME and UUE. A user intending to download binaries should choose a client capable of handling files encoded in either of these schemes. yEnc is the most frequently used scheme in alt.binaries.

Header and Message Body: A header is that part that carries meta-information—like NG address, poster address, subject, encoding scheme etc. The message body carries the actual message or attachment. Most clients can download just the headers of messages allowing you to judge whether to download the message body as well. This saves a lot of time and bandwidth.

7.1.3 Newsreaders

A few Newsreaders are discussed next.

7.1.3.1 Xana News

To use it, under the Accounts menu use the New Account link. Here you can enter details like screen name and the NNTP server address. After the necessary details are entered, the server shows up on the left frame. The next step is to get the list of newsgroups available on the server. This can be done by clicking on the “Show Newsgroup List” after selecting the server. Depending on the number of NGs in the server, this could take a long time, but this needs to be done only once (or rarely). The list of all the NGs on the server is displayed.

To quickly find an NG on a certain topic the Filter box can be used. To subscribe to an interesting NG, select it from the list click on the subscribe button alongside. After subscription, the NGs show up under the server name. If needed, all the new messages in all the groups can be downloaded simultaneously by selecting the server and clicking on the Get Messages link under the NG menu. Alternatively, messages from the groups can be individually downloaded by selecting the relevant NG and using the Get Messages link.



The Xana News interface